**GG-E(SL)**

| Question Paper No. |
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| E3300680 |

Countersigned on verification
Officer-in-Charge
(with Office Seal)

Signature of the Invigilator

Centre .....

# 2026

# ENGLISH
## (Second Language)

**Time : 3 Hours 15 Minutes**

*(First 15 Minutes for reading the question paper only,*
*3 Hours for writing)*

**Full Marks : 90**

Roll _____ No. _____

Name _____

Registration No. _____

***Answer ALL the questions in the space provided. There is enough space for the answers. However, extra sheets will be supplied by the invigilator, if required.***

***Special credit will be given for answers which are brief and to the point. Marks will be deducted for spelling mistakes, untidiness and bad handwriting.***

**Section - A** - *Reading Comprehension (Seen) - 20 marks*
*Reading Comprehension (Unseen) - 20 marks*

**Section - B** - *Grammar and Vocabulary - 20 marks*

**Section - C** - *Writing - 30 marks*

| Q | Marks |
|---|---|
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## SECTION - A

## READING COMPREHENSION (SEEN)

**1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow :**

Of course, there was nobody for us to play with on the Big Half Moon. We just had to make the most of each other, and we did.

We live on the Big Half Moon island. 'We' are Father and Claude and I and Aunt Esther and Mimi and Dick. It used to be only Father and Claude and I. It is all on account of the kite that there are more of us. This is what I want to tell you about.

Father is the keeper of the Big Half Moon Lighthouse. I am eleven years old. Claude is twelve. In winter, when the harbour is frozen over, we all move over to the mainland. As soon as spring comes, back we sail to our own dear island.

The funny part used to be that people always pitied us when the time came for us to return. They said we must be so lonesome over there, with no other children near us. Of course Claude and I would have liked to have someone to play with us. It is hard to run pirate caves and things like that with only two. But we used to quarrel a good deal with the mainland children in winter. So it was perhaps just as well that there were none of them on the Big Half Moon. Claude and I never quarrelled.

To be sure, Father didn't seem to have any relations except us. This used to puzzle Claude and me. Everybody on the mainland had relations. Why hadn't we? Was it because we lived on an island? We thought it would be so jolly to have an uncle and aunt and some cousins. Once we asked Father about it, but he looked so sorrowful that we wished we hadn't. He said it was all his fault. Claude and I didn't understand what he meant.

**A. Write the correct alternative in the given space to complete the following sentences:**

$1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) Big Half Moon is the name of a/an

(i) hotel ☐ (ii) city ☐

(iii) island ☐ (iv) tower ☐

Ans: _____

(b) The age of Claude is

(i) eleven years ☐ (ii) twelve years ☐

(iii) fifteen years ☐ (iv) ten years ☐

Ans: _____

(c) Esther is the

(i) cousin of Claude and the narrator ☐ (ii) mother of the narrator and Claude ☐

(iii) neighbour of the narrator's father ☐ (iv) sister of the narrator's father ☐

Ans: _____

(d) Claude and the narrator used to quarrel

(i) with the mainland children ☐ (ii) among themselves only ☐

(iii) with their cousins ☐ (iv) with other children of the island ☐

Ans: _____

(e) Father looked sad when

(i) the children felt lonely ☐ (ii) aunt Esther was found ☐

(iii) the family left the island ☐ (iv) he was asked about relatives ☐

Ans: _____

**B. Complete the following sentences with information from the text:** $1 \times 3 = 3$

(i) The father of the two children worked as

_____

(ii) The family used to move over to the mainland because

_____

(iii) People of the mainland pitied the narrator's family when

_____

**C. State whether the following statements are 'True' or 'False'. Write 'T' or 'F' in boxes and provide supporting statements:** $2 \times 2 = 4$

(i) The family found their relative because of the kite. ☐

Supporting statement:

_____

_____

(ii) No family living on the mainland had relatives. ☐

Supporting statement:

_____

_____

**2. Read the poem and answer the questions that follow :**

To grass, or leaf, or fruit or wall
The snail sticks close, nor fears to fall
As if he grew there, house and all
Together.

Within that house secure he hides
When danger imminent betides
Of storm, or other harm besides
Of weather.

Give but his horns the slightest touch,
His self-collecting pow'r is such,
He shrinks into his house with much
Displeasure.

Where'er he dwells, he dwells alone,
Except himself has chattels none
Well satisfied to be his own
Whole treasure.

Thus, hermit-like, his life he leads,
Nor partner of his banquet needs,
And if he meets one, only feeds
The faster.

**A. Tick the correct alternative:** $1 \times 4 = 4$

(a) The snail sticks to the wall as if

(i) he grew there ☐ (ii) it is afraid to fall ☐

(iii) he is fond of it ☐ (iv) it is his house ☐

(b) With the slightest touch the snail shrinks with

(i) disappointment ☐ (ii) delight ☐

(iii) displeasure ☐ (iv) defiance ☐

(c) The phrase "danger imminent" in the second stanza refers to dangers

(i) that cannot be faced ☐ (ii) likely to happen soon ☐

(iii) being faced at present ☐ (iv) that happened in the past ☐

(d) Wherever the snail lives, it lives

(i) with family ☐ (ii) with chattels ☐

(iii) with friends ☐ (iv) with none ☐

**B. Answer the following questions:** $2 \times 2 = 4$

(i) What does the snail do when it meets another snail?

_____

_____

(ii) With whose life is the life of the snail compared and what similarity can be found in their lives?

_____

_____

## SECTION B - GRAMMAR AND VOCABULARY

**4. Choose the correct alternatives to fill in the blanks:** $1 \times 3 = 3$

One day the Giant _____ (comes/came/was coming) back. He _____ (had been/has been/was) to visit his friend the Cornish Ogre and _____ (was staying/had stayed/had been staying) with him for seven years.

**5. Do as directed**

**A. Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles and prepositions:** $1 \times 3 = 3$

On 4th August 2023 _____ Indian women's archery team achieved a historic feat _____ securing the gold medal _____ the World Archery Championship in Berlin.

**B.** $1 \times 3 = 3$

(i) My father lives in a big house. The house is near the river. (Join into a single sentence)

Ans: _____

(ii) "You are half an hour late," Samuel said. (Change into indirect speech)

Ans: _____

(iii) At every station sorrowful crowds filled the platform. (Change the voice)

Ans: _____

**C. Choose the correct phrasal verbs... [put on, give up, give in, bring out]** $1 \times 3 = 3$

(i) Nandini has <u>published</u> her first novel. ☐

(ii) I will <u>wear</u> a new dress tomorrow. ☐

(iii) We should <u>abandon</u> bad habits. ☐

## SECTION C - WRITING

**7. Write a story (in about 100 words) using the following hints...**

A dog crossing a bridge over a stream - a piece of flesh in mouth - sees the image in water - takes it for another dog - becomes greedy - jumps down.

**8. Write a notice (in about 100 words) for the students announcing a magic show...**

**9. Write a letter (in about 100 words) to your cousin advising him/her to plant saplings...**